

Impact Low · Difficulty Medium · Misuse risk The move fails when every question is secretly a setup for self-display — you as

THE MOVE

Ask -> listen -> follow-up or reflect -> optional brief share -> return. -> Question + support response + small self-disclosure + return question. -> "I have a version of that too, but I want to hear yours first." -> "That reminds me of something, but ?"

START HERE

Ask one real follow-up or reflect before sharing your related story.

SAY THIS

Stop the boomerang	<i>"Before I make this about me — what happened next?"</i>
Support before shifting	<i>"That sounds like the main part of the story."</i>
Bridge to self without...	<i>"I've had a smaller version of that, but yours sounds more intense."</i>
Return to them	<i>"Anyway, back to yours — what happened after that?"</i>
Good news	<i>"That is a proper win. What was the best moment?"</i>
Stress / frustration	<i>"That sounds draining. What was the hardest part?"</i>

AVOID

- The other person explicitly asks about your experience or opinion.
- A balanced back-and-forth is already established and your story genuinely adds value.
- You over-correct and ask so many questions that it becomes an interview.

REMEMBER

If the question is really a doorway to your story, don't ask it yet.